

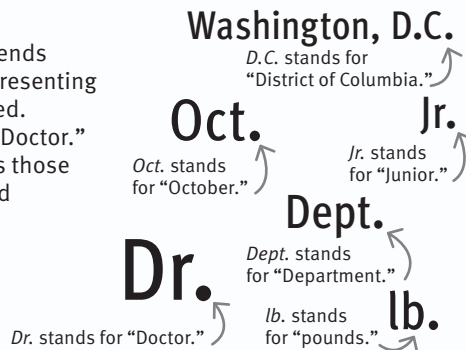


- When using **abbreviations**, be consistent and either always use periods, or never use them.
- Most **acronyms**, such as **NASA** or **NATO**, should be written without periods.

In **telegrams**, the word **STOP** was used to mark the **end of a sentence** instead of a period, because it **cost less** than punctuation.

Abbreviations

A period can be used at the ends of certain abbreviations, representing letters that have been omitted. For example, *Dr.* stands for “Doctor.” Some abbreviations, such as those for metric measurements and US states, are never spelled with a period.



GLOSSARY

Abbreviation A shortened form of a word, often with one or more periods to represent missing letters.

Acronym An abbreviation made up of the initial letters of a series of words and in which the letters are pronounced as they are spelled, rather than as separate letters.

Command A sentence that gives an instruction.

Statement A sentence that conveys a fact or piece of information.

Leading scientist Dr. Fisher
Wait, I forgot to tell you...”

Ellipses

Three periods in a row are called an ellipsis. An ellipsis indicates that a sentence has been left unfinished, as when a speaker drifts into silence or is cut off abruptly. Ellipses can also represent omitted text within quotations.

This ellipsis stands for the missing words from the start of the sentence in the quotation. The missing words could be “Today we heard that.”

The report said that “...Dr. Fisher...is correct....The island is near...”

If text is omitted after a complete sentence, the ellipsis is placed after the final punctuation mark.

I thought...

This ellipsis means that the speaker suddenly stopped speaking. No period is needed.

Could I...?

A question mark or exclamation point is kept after an ellipsis.

This ellipsis indicates missing text. Some style guides suggest placing spaces before and after the ellipsis.